
Phishing Attack

Phishing is a type of cybercrime in which attackers try to trick individuals into revealing sensitive information such as passwords, bank details, or OTPs by pretending to be a trusted entity. It usually happens through emails, messages, or fake websites that look legitimate.

A typical phishing attack follows several steps. First, the attacker creates a fake message that appears to come from a trusted source like a bank or popular website. Second, the message contains a link that redirects the user to a fake website designed to look identical to the real one. Third, the victim enters their login credentials or personal details on this fake site. Finally, the attacker collects this information and uses it for unauthorized access or financial fraud.

Students, working professionals, and elderly people are common targets, especially those who are less aware of online security practices. Phishing attacks can lead to serious consequences such as loss of money, identity theft, and unauthorized access to personal accounts.

For example, a student might receive an email claiming their bank account will be blocked unless they verify their details. In panic, they click the link and enter their information, unknowingly giving access to the attacker.

This situation could be avoided by checking the authenticity of emails, avoiding suspicious links, and enabling two-factor authentication. Awareness and cautious behavior are key to preventing phishing attacks.

Stay Safe Online – Prevention Checklist (For College Students in India)

General Safety Tips

- Use strong, unique passwords for all accounts and enable two-factor authentication (2FA)

- Never click on suspicious links in emails, SMS, or social media messages
- Always verify the sender before sharing personal or academic information
- Keep your devices and apps updated to avoid security vulnerabilities
- Avoid using public Wi-Fi for sensitive activities like banking or logging into important accounts
- Check website URLs carefully (look for HTTPS and correct spelling)

UPI & Financial Safety Tips

- Never share your UPI PIN, OTP, or bank details with anyone
- Do not approve unknown payment requests (Collect Requests) on apps like [Google Pay], [PhonePe], or [Paytm]
- Always double-check the receiver's name before sending money
- Install only official banking or payment apps from trusted app stores

Reporting Cybercrime in India

- Report incidents at: <https://cybercrime.gov.in>
- Call Cyber Crime Helpline: 1930 for immediate assistance